CRIMINALIZING REPORTING

Georgia v. Mzia Amaglobeli

9 October 2026

CASE FOLLOW-UP REPORT

Procedural developments and verified outcomes

Independent research based on user-supplied TrialWatch materials

ABOUT THIS UPDATE

This independent research update follows the user-supplied TrialWatch material. It is not issued by the Clooney Foundation for Justice, TrialWatch, or the original authors. The earlier report supplies the historical baseline; later developments are supported by the sources cited here.

Jurisdiction	Georgia
Original report	January 2026
Dated update covered	21 September 2026
Research cutoff	9 October 2026
Historical assessment	TrialWatch grade D (original report only)

SCOPE AND METHOD

Research considered public court records, enacted legislation, lawyers and subjects, press-freedom organizations, United Nations materials and attributable reporting available through 9 October 2026. Publication dates and event dates are distinguished. Where judgments or current custody records could not be obtained, the conclusion is expressly qualified. No direct interviews or new trial monitoring were conducted for this update.

An acquittal, quashing order, pardon, sentence completion, bail decision and custody transfer have different legal effects. A reported intention to litigate is separated from an actual filing. Unresolved questions are listed below. Historical TrialWatch grades retain their original attribution; this update does not assign a new grade.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

LATEST VERIFIED POSITION

Reported imprisoned; Supreme Court declined cassation; ECHR complaints filed

21 September is the publication date of a CMIS report covering September 2025-August 2026, not a new detention order. Latest verified domestic criminal disposition: Supreme Court nonadmission on 4 March 2026. A conviction-related ECHR application was reportedly filed 26 June and registered 3 July. No release or ECHR merits judgment was verified through 9 October.

The Supreme Court declined to admit Amaglobeli's cassation appeal on 4 March 2026; this was not a new merits judgment. Subsequent reporting confirms that the previously planned Strasbourg challenge to the conviction became an actual application, filed on 26 June and registered on 3 July. [2] [5]

The latest specific account located, published by CMIS on 21 September 2026 and covering developments through August, described her as imprisoned, reported refusal of early release, and counted four European Court of Human Rights applications. Registration of those complaints does not itself establish admissibility, a violation or release. [7]

2. Committee to Protect Journalists, 4 March 2026. Georgia's Supreme Court rejects jailed journa...

5. The Messenger, 7 August 2026. EU, Rights Groups Call for Release of Georgia...

7. Center for Media, Information a..., 21 September 2026. The State of Journalists' Safety in Georgia -...

BACKGROUND AND PROCEDURAL HISTORY

The January 2026 original concerned Amaglobeli, founder of Batumelebi and Netgazeti, following her arrest during protests in Batumi in January 2025. The prosecution initially charged an attack on a police officer. On 6 August 2025 the court convicted her instead under Article 353(1), concerning resistance to an officer, and sentenced her to two years. The Kutaisi Court of Appeal upheld that result on 18 November 2025. The original already covered those appellate hearings; they are not post-report discoveries. [1]

TrialWatch expert Sir Nicolas Bratza assigned a D. The assessment identified inadequate notice of the substituted charge, impaired access to defense materials and witnesses, participation problems associated with the courtroom glass enclosure, prejudicial statements by public officials, and inadequate justification for imprisonment. This follow-up attributes those findings to the original report rather than issuing a new grade or independently adopting every allegation as judicially established. [1]

KEY PROCEDURAL DATES

6 August 2025	Conviction on the substituted Article 353(1) charge and two-year sentence. [1]
18 November 2025	Kutaisi Court of Appeal upheld conviction and sentence. [1]
14 January 2026	GYLA reported two already-filed Strasbourg cases, concerning detention rather than the later cassation disposition. [3]
4 March 2026	Supreme Court declined admission of cassation; a separate ill-treatment ECHR application was also filed that day. [2] [4]
11 March 2026	Third, ill-treatment-related Strasbourg application registered, according to Batumelebi. [4]
26 June 2026	Conviction and fair-trial application submitted, according to GYLA as reported by The Messenger. [5]
3 July 2026	Fourth application registered, according to the same report. [5]
11 September 2026	Georgia Today published Amaglobeli's prison letter awaiting international justice. [6]
21 September 2026	CMIS published its through-August review reporting imprisonment, early-release refusal and four Strasbourg applications. [7]

1. User-supplied original report, January 2026.
2. Committee to Protect Journalists, 4 March 2026. Georgia's Supreme Court rejects jailed journa...
3. Georgian Young Lawyers' Associa..., 14 January 2026. Mzia Amaglobeli's cases before the Strasbourg...
4. Batumelebi, 2 April 2026. Report on registration of a third Strasbourg...
5. The Messenger, 7 August 2026. EU, Rights Groups Call for Release of Georgia...
6. Georgia Today, 11 September 2026. Mzia Amaghlobeli: I await international justi...
7. Center for Media, Information a..., 21 September 2026. The State of Journalists' Safety in Georgia -...

SUBSEQUENT DEVELOPMENTS

CPJ reported nonadmission on 4 March, citing her lawyers' criticism that the Supreme Court had not addressed their admissibility arguments. CPJ also recorded an intention to appeal to Strasbourg. That statement alone would not prove a filing; the later records must supply the missing procedural step. [2]

GYLA's 14 January update identified two different Strasbourg proceedings already in existence: application 13661/25, filed on 28 April 2025 concerning criminal detention, and application 36304/25, filed on 17 November 2025 concerning administrative detention. In the first, the government had submitted observations in October 2025 and GYLA had responded by January. The alleged violations were the applicants' claims, not Strasbourg findings. [3]

Batumelebi reported a third application alleging police ill-treatment and deficiencies in its investigation. It was submitted on 4 March 2026 and registered on 11 March, with notification received on 1 April. Sharing a date with the Supreme Court decision does not make this complaint the conviction appeal. [4]

The Messenger subsequently reported GYLA's announcement of a fourth complaint: the conviction and fair-trial challenge, submitted on 26 June and registered on 3 July. It concerned the prosecution and proceedings at all three domestic court levels. The account identified GYLA and Edward Fitzgerald as representatives. The filing is verified through reporting of counsel's statement, not an independently retrieved Strasbourg docket. [5]

In a prison letter published on 11 September, Amaglobeli said she was awaiting international justice and rejected seeking a pardon through an apology. CMIS's later publication also reported refusal of early release and obstacles to visiting her. Neither source identifies a subsequent favorable judgment; the precise early-release decision date and written reasons remain unverified. [6] [7]

LEGAL AND PROCEDURAL ASSESSMENT

The following assessment draws inferences from the cited record. It does not represent a new court finding or TrialWatch grade.

the strongest procedural change is a move from domestic cassation nonadmission to an actually filed international challenge. The four applications must not be collapsed into one: detention, administrative detention, ill-treatment and the conviction raise different factual and procedural questions. Their existence is evidence of litigation, not success in that litigation. [3] [4] [5]

a two-year sentence cannot be used to calculate present liberty or a guaranteed release day. The available later accounts still described imprisonment. Any future report should obtain a specific custody or release record and identify the outcome of each Strasbourg case separately before changing that characterization. [6] [7]

2. Committee to Protect Journalists, 4 March 2026. Georgia's Supreme Court rejects jailed journa...
3. Georgian Young Lawyers' Associa..., 14 January 2026. Mzia Amaglobeli's cases before the Strasbourg...
4. Batumelebi, 2 April 2026. Report on registration of a third Strasbourg...
5. The Messenger, 7 August 2026. EU, Rights Groups Call for Release of Georgia...
6. Georgia Today, 11 September 2026. Mzia Amaghlobeli: I await international justi...
7. Center for Media, Information a..., 21 September 2026. The State of Journalists' Safety in Georgia -...

CONCLUSION AND OUTSTANDING RECORDS

The verified follow-up is unsuccessful access to domestic cassation and multiple actual Strasbourg applications, including the conviction challenge. The public record located does not justify describing Amaglobeli as released, pardoned or exonerated.

RECORDS NOT VERIFIED

1. Supreme Court's complete nonadmission order and precise admissibility reasoning.

2. Application number and official procedural status of the June 2026 conviction complaint and March 2026 ill-treatment complaint.

3. Any ECHR admissibility, interim-measure or merits ruling; registration is not such a ruling.

4. Date, decision-maker, written reasons and review status of the reported early-release refusal.

5. Custody confirmation covering the interval after the September publication through 9 October, or any intervening release order.

Failure to locate an update leaves a gap in the available evidence; it does not establish that no later proceeding or change occurred. Any present-status claim should be read with the dated scope stated in the executive summary.

SOURCES AND REFERENCES

Numbered references correspond to superscript citations and page notes. Web sources were consulted for this research through 9 October 2026. Original reports are local user-supplied files. Each link opens the cited source.

1. **Original user-supplied report on Georgia v. Mzia Amaglobeli**
TrialWatch / original report authors. January 2026.
Local PDF: georgia-v-mzia-amaglobeli.pdf
Coverage: Historical case baseline and original assessment

2. **Georgia's Supreme Court rejects jailed journalist Mzia Amaglobeli's appeal**
Committee to Protect Journalists. 4 March 2026.
Read source at cpj.org
Coverage: Cassation not admitted on 4 March; then-stated plan for Strasbourg

3. **Mzia Amaglobeli's cases before the Strasbourg Court**
Georgian Young Lawyers' Association. 14 January 2026.
Read source at gyla.ge
Coverage: Applications 13661/25 and 36304/25; filing dates; observations in detention case

4. **Report on registration of a third Strasbourg application for Mzia Amaglobeli**
Batumelebi. 2 April 2026.
Read source at batumelebi.netgazeti.ge
Coverage: Ill-treatment application submitted 4 March; registered 11 March; notification 1 April

5. **EU, Rights Groups Call for Release of Georgian Journalist Mzia Amaglobeli One Year After Sentencing**
The Messenger. 7 August 2026.
Read source at www.messenger.com.ge
Coverage: Conviction complaint filed 26 June; registered 3 July; fourth Strasbourg application

6. **Mzia Amaghlobeli: I await international justice, you should wait too, Mr. Papuashvili**
Georgia Today. 11 September 2026.
Read source at georgiatoday.ge
Coverage: Prison letter; awaiting international proceedings; refusal to seek pardon through apology

7. **The State of Journalists' Safety in Georgia - September 2025-August 2026**
Center for Media, Information and Social Research. 21 September 2026.
Read source at cmis.ge
Coverage: Reported imprisonment and early-release refusal during covered period; four Strasbourg applications